MOUNTAINSIDE

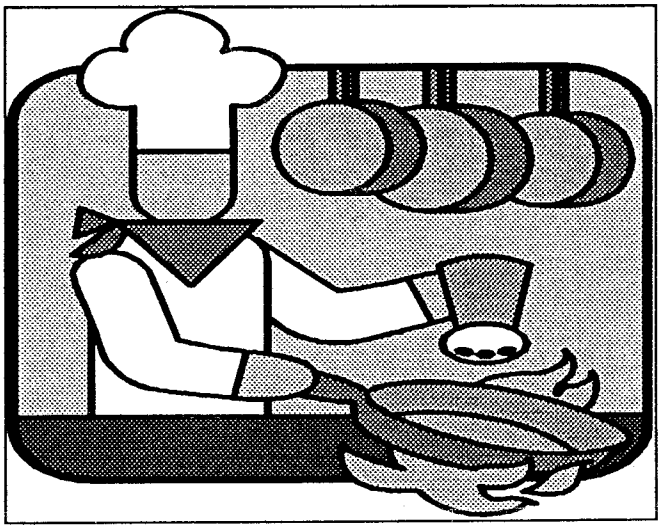
April 1994 Volume 2 Issue 4

NEW BALLOTS TO BE SOLICITED

New England town hall meetings have nothing on us. We had one on April 9th with nearly fifty members of the association. (forty members sent ballots) The central topic was the quality of our community and the business realities that accompany ownership of common lands and the infrastructure that serves every member. Four hours and more with one fifteen minute break proved that CMA members were interested and vocal in all viewpoints offered by their neighbors. Suggestions were made for clarifying certain terms of the agreement developed by CMA and CDC. Commentary ranged from providing more factual detail on contemplated business dealings to scrapping those parts of the expansion which reached onto present CMA common lands. Concerns were offered regarding traffic, safety, capacity of water and sewer systems to handle expansion, and whether or not CMA received fair value in the negotiated settlement. John Lewis, the CMA engineer answered member questions regarding the present status of our infrastructure and Don Green, a long time CMA member and legal consultant for our arbitration offered his views on settlement options. Future relationships with the Coolfont Development Corporation received substantial attention. Randall Ashelman, the project manager selected to direct the expansion project if it is approved, also addressed the audience.

Stronger Lessons *Have you learn'd lessons only of those who admired you and were tender with you and stood aside you? Have you not learned great lessons from those who reject you, and brace themselves against you? or who treat you with contempt, or dispute the passage with you?*
Walt Whitman

The CMA Board of Directors was commended by the membership for their leadership. All in all, the meeting was judged to be free of acrimony and well focused on legitimate and timely issues. Stan Bigelow, past president and organizer of opposing points of view stated that he felt telling viewpoints were given a fair hearing. New members participated in the discussion and offered suggestions to improve communications. The outcome of the meeting suggested that the CMA Board of Directors review the presently recommended course of action, and as necessary, develop new agreement language, provide members with rationale for additional inclusions and present changes to the membership for final approval.



Dinner is not quite ready!

New Timetable for Infrastructure Upgrades To Be Set By CMA Board

Responding to member requests for agreement clarifications, management plans and other particulars, the CMA Board of Directors will be setting new dates for continuing negotiation with CDC, extending the arbitration deadline date and receiving reports from engineering consultants on expansion possibilities and upgrade options. Some decisions will be reached soon, others will be the subject of the next Board of Directors meeting set for Sat. May 7th, 10:00 A.M. at the Davis Library, 6400 Democracy Blvd., Bethesda. Preliminary findings of the CMA Long Term Budget Planning Committee will have a bearing on future CMA-CDC business activities as well as setting in motion principles for use in 94-95 budget planning. Planning and approvals for construction take months, so the pressure is on if any upgrade work is to be conducted this year. CMA hopes to begin a construction project to upgrade water and sewer systems to prevent costly upkeep and improve water pressure and reliability.

Run for office or serve on a committee.

The fall of 1994 is not that far away. Old commitees will be retired and new committees and task forces will be formed. Your time and talent are welcome. 1995 will be a year for renewal. Join us! Call (202) 333-7697.

FIRE HAZARDS - YOURS TO PREVENT

NO. We don't have written fire safety rules, but let's all try these on for size: 1.) Clean flues. The chemical build up in a flue can be the cause of a house fire. It happened once in our community. Get someone who knows what they're doing when cleaning flues. 2.) No campfires! We're not a camp. Wind and sparks are lethal. Yes. CRI has been advised that we don't want camp fires. 3.) Don't leave combustibles around, old paint cans included. 4.) Candlelight? Sure for a romantic evening , if they stay on the table (the candles that is). Leaving candles and matches around a rental home isn't too swift. 5.) Cut branches or trees that could impede the movement of fire trucks. They want 12 feet. Once the Berkeley Springs Volunteer Fire Department marked trees and branches and most of us ignored their suggestions! 6.) 4th of July celebrations?.. try NY Harbor. 7.) Barbecue pits and apparatus. Place these items away from trees or dry grasses. Empty hot briquets into metal cans and soak with water or close pit lids, shut out the air and let the whole mess burn out. 8.) Electrical appliances? Everyone of them is a potential hazard. Disconnect if you're leaving for long periods. 9.) The kitchen. Lets not repeat the old "potholder got too close to the burner" routine. Clean grease from ovens and drip pans. 10.) Frayed electric wiring?. Fix it. Beat up appliances?; buy new ones. 11.) Cigarettes? Try these ideas for signs: This Is A No Smoking House or, This Is A No Smoking Forest. 12.) Solvents? Cap them well. 13.) ID your home (road sign). Why call the fire dept. if they can't find your place?! Make sure you're on the Coolfont map. *Thanks,Smokey*

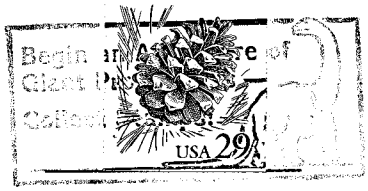


NOW IS GOOD TIME TO INSPECT YOUR COOLFONT HOME. CLEAN AROUND FURNACE AND STOVE AREAS. REFRESH EXTINGUISHERS. MAKE SURE FIRE ESCAPE AREAS ARE CLEAR. SIGNS FOR RENTERS ON OPEN BURNING? GO FOR IT! KIDS? GIVE THEM SOME LESSONS.

MOUNTAINSIDE

CMA
3717 S Street N.W.
Washington D.C. 20007





Jim & Joan Bradfield
4 Lorraine Ct.
Rockville, MD 20852

inside...

Another vote? The winner of the last...*democracy*!
Fire Safety. It's Your Business
Next Board of Directors Meeting
Run for Office!